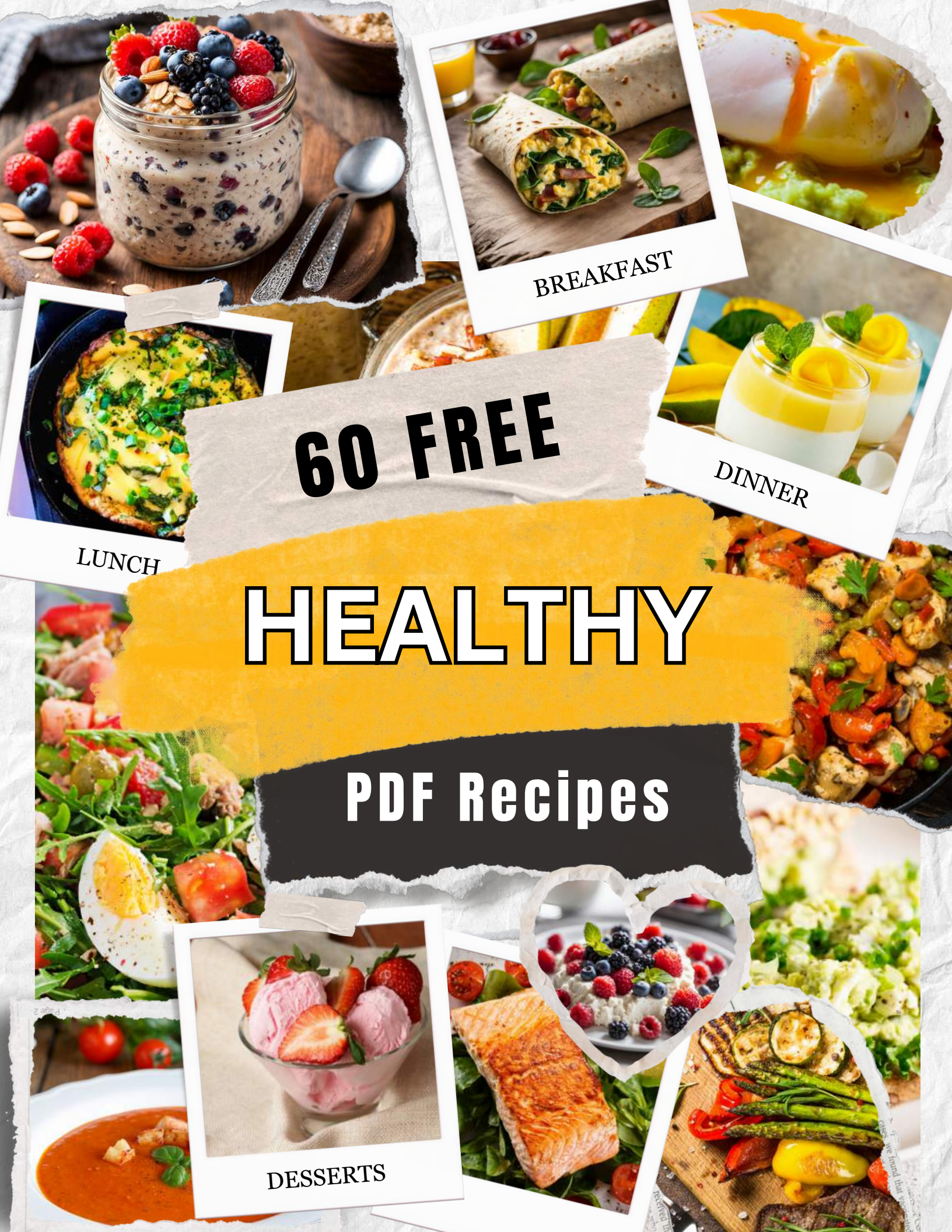

60 FREE HEALTHY

PDF Recipes

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INTRODUCTION

I hope you enjoy this selection of healthy recipes which I have put together.

The recipes are just a few which I am sharing in my collection, there are plenty more that you can discover on my website "Cooking With Emily."

A few years ago, I needed to remove just over 3 stone (42 lbs) for health reasons. And whilst my weight loss was about good exercise (trail running) I also needed to be more mindful of how I ate and how to fuel my body.

BEFORE & AFTER

It wasn't easy. Fully menopausal aged 50, and also emotionally not in a good space, I needed to get a grip. This was more than vanity; it was so I could live a healthier life without medications and interventions. I quickly learnt what worked for me. I had to push on the exercise, but I also needed food that made me feel full and gave me energy.

The weight came off within a few months, but what gave me greater joy was that I started to feel so much fitter. I went from not being able to run down the road, to doing Ultra Marathons (45Km) in the hills of the Lake District.

Food was a major part. I cook, write recipes for a living, and so naturally enjoy the naughty foods that I also produce. However, I now have a diet that is 85% good food and can enjoy the 15% treat element, without causing weight gain. For over 4 years, I have kept the weight off and although I do my running and training, I make sure that I eat as much good wholesome food as possible.

The one thing that helped me was having a few food dishes to hand. We all get those days when we need some inspiration of what to cook or put together to eat. This is that guide. As I have said, there are many more on my website (some of which have video) that you can reference. By all means, if there is an ingredient you are not keen of, then swap it for another that you do like, as long as its a healthy swap. This healthy recipe pdf is to help give you a guide.

Please ensure that before you start any new regime that you take advice from your doctor. This is important for many groups including diabetics. Also keep to your medications and again stick to GP advice.

One question I always get asked is about intermittent fasting and helping hunger pangs. I intermittent fast until 1pm most days. However, when I am doing a long run, then I will fuel up before I go with a decent breakfast. I would stop eating at 7pm and not eat until 7am. Gradually over time I was able to extend this to 1pm.

Eating, snacking and alcohol at night stopped, unless there was a special occasion. My body needed to stop digesting food and get a break.

Fibre was my friend against hunger pangs. Fibre swells up and makes you feel fuller for longer. I didn't get overly hung up with protein, but did add more into my diet than before. I also got a grip of my portion control. That was ***way*** out of hand. Most recipes are for one, but many of the main meals are for two people.

My mental outlook over it all is better too. Stop thinking diet, and think of a new regime where you feel the benefits of increased health. I remember the day I changed my lifestyle. It was just after Easter, where I was told by a consultant to reduce my weight by 3 stone. I sat and ate my chocolate egg and sobbed. I went on my first run and removed all bad influence food in my home. However that day, all I could do was feel sorry for myself and hold a pity party.

The difference to actually succeeding this time with weight loss and fitness, was consistency. I kept diaries and logs of my exercise and food. I could see weight coming off, my skin looking better, I had more energy and was running further than I did as a teenager! These diaries helped me no end. I could see how far I had come and that was a massive motivation to me.

So my final words to you are, is that do it gradually. Do it not just because you will look better, but because your insides will be delighted that your body will work better.

Oh and take no notice of other people and their opinions. If I had listened to their sarcastic remarks, I would not be still running and living healthy and well almost 5 years on! I think some were hoping I would fail. Live your life for you. Do it for you. Stay in your own lane, and most of all do not go comparing yourself to others. Remember you are unique, there is only one of you.

You got this!

Emily x

BREAKFAST IDEAS

These are some breakfast ideas. Being totally honest, as I mentioned in the introduction, I tend to skip breakfast as I intermittent fast most days. The exception to this, is where I am away on holiday or if I am doing one of my longer runs.

Some of these ideas I move to lunch. One of my favourites being avocado and poached egg on whole grain or sourdough toast.

Whatever you do, do not cave into breakfast cereal. Even the so called healthier ones are laden full of nasties. You will also note that I never use low cal, low fat or any substitute for real food such as butter. For the most part they taste nasty and second, there is more research coming out to say that they are not that great for health.

I lost my weight with full fat proper food. A lot of it comes down to portion control, discipline and moderation.

OVERNIGHT OATS WITH CHIA SEEDS AND ALMOND BUTTER

INGREDIENTS

- 40G (1/2 CUP) ROLLED OATS
- 15G (1 TABLESPOON) CHIA SEEDS
- 15G (1 TABLESPOON) ALMOND BUTTER
- 120ML (1/2 CUP) UNSWEETENED ALMOND MILK (OR ANY MILK OF CHOICE)
- 2.5ML (1/2 TEASPOON) HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP (OPTIONAL)
- FRESH BERRIES OR WHY NOT TRY MY FAVOURITE PEARS, MIXED NUTS AND CINNAMON DUSTING (FOR TOPPING)
- A PINCH OF CINNAMON (OPTIONAL)

"Eat food that nourishes your body, not just your cravings."

Start your day with this easy and healthy breakfast recipe: Overnight Oats with Chia Seeds and Almond Butter. Packed with protein, fibre, and healthy fats, this no-cook breakfast is a perfect meal prep option for busy mornings. The combination of rolled oats, chia seeds, and almond butter will keep you feeling full and energised throughout the day. Simply prepare it the night before, and you'll have a nutritious, on-the-go breakfast ready to enjoy. It's a great way to add more fibre and healthy fats to your diet while keeping breakfast simple and delicious.

- IN A MASON JAR OR BOWL, COMBINE THE OATS, CHIA SEEDS, ALMOND BUTTER, AND ALMOND MILK.
- STIR WELL TO COMBINE, ENSURING THE ALMOND BUTTER IS FULLY MIXED IN.
- ADD HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP FOR SWEETNESS (OPTIONAL).
- COVER AND REFRIGERATE OVERNIGHT (OR AT LEAST FOR 4 HOURS).
- IN THE MORNING, STIR THE OATS AND TOP WITH FRESH BERRIES AND A SPRINKLE OF CINNAMON.
- ENJOY CHILLED OR AT ROOM TEMPERATURE.

APPROXIMATE VALUES PER SERVING
CALORIES: 300 KCAL, PROTEIN: 8G, FAT: 16G, SATURATED FAT: 2G, CARBOHYDRATES: 32G, FIBRE: 6G, SUGARS: 7G, SODIUM: 50MG, CALCIUM: 250MG, IRON: 2MG

SPINACH, FETA & RED PEPPER BREAKFAST WRAP WITH EGG WHITES

INGREDIENTS

- 1 LARGE WHOLE WHEAT WRAP (ABOUT 25 CM / 10 INCHES)
- 4 LARGE EGG WHITES
- 30 G (1 OZ) FETA CHEESE, CRUMBLED
- 50 G (1.75 OZ) FRESH SPINACH
- 1 SMALL RED PEPPER, FINELY CHOPPED (ABOUT 50 G / 1.75 OZ)
- 1 TSP OLIVE OIL
- SALT AND PEPPER, TO TASTE

"*Your only limit is you.*"

Enjoy a healthy and delicious start to your day with this Spinach, Feta & Red Pepper Breakfast Wrap with Egg Whites. Packed with fresh spinach, creamy feta, scrambled egg whites, and the sweet crunch of red peppers, this breakfast wrap is a protein-rich, light meal that will keep you energised throughout the morning. It's perfect for busy mornings or meal prep, offering a nutritious balance of flavours.

- Heat a non-stick pan over medium heat and add the olive oil. Once the oil is hot, add the chopped red pepper and cook for 1-2 minutes until softened. Add the spinach and cook for an additional 1-2 minutes until wilted. Remove from the pan and set aside.
- In the same pan, pour in the egg whites. Cook over low heat, stirring gently to scramble the eggs until they are fully cooked and fluffy. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
- Lay the whole wheat wrap on a flat surface. First, spread the cooked spinach and red pepper mixture in the centre of the wrap, followed by the scrambled egg whites. Sprinkle the crumbled feta cheese on top.

CONTINUED

- Fold in the sides of the wrap and roll it up tightly, ensuring all the ingredients are securely wrapped inside.
- Slice the wrap in half and enjoy immediately or wrap it up for a portable, on-the-go breakfast.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING):

- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 21 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 28 G
- FAT: 12 G
- FIBRE: 6 G
- SUGAR: 4 G

AVOCADO AND POACHED EGG ON WHOLE GRAIN TOAST

INGREDIENTS

- 1 SLICE WHOLE GRAIN BREAD (OR GLUTEN-FREE BREAD, IF PREFERRED)
- 1 RIPE AVOCADO
- 1 LARGE EGG
- 1 TEASPOON OLIVE OIL (OPTIONAL, FOR SPREADING ON TOAST)
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- A SPRINKLE OF RED PEPPER FLAKES (OPTIONAL)
- FRESH HERBS (E.G., PARSLEY OR CHIVES) FOR GARNISH (OPTIONAL)

"*A healthy outside starts from the inside.*"

This simple, energising breakfast is perfect for those who want a quick, satisfying meal. The creamy avocado combined with a perfectly poached egg offers healthy fats, protein, and plenty of energy to start your day. With whole grain toast for fibre, this breakfast will keep you full and fuelled through the morning.

- Toast the slice of whole grain bread until golden and crispy.
- While the bread is toasting, bring a small pot of water to a gentle simmer. Add a dash of vinegar (optional) to help the egg whites set.
- Crack the egg into a small bowl and carefully slide it into the simmering water. Poach for 3-4 minutes for a soft, runny yolk.
- While the egg is cooking, cut the avocado in half, remove the pit, and scoop the flesh into a small bowl. Mash with a fork and season with salt and pepper to taste.

CONTINUED

- Once the toast is ready, spread olive oil (if using) on top of the bread, then spread the mashed avocado evenly over the toast.
- Remove the poached egg from the water, drain any excess water, and place it gently on top of the avocado toast.
- Garnish with a sprinkle of red pepper flakes and fresh herbs, if desired.
- Serve immediately and enjoy!

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING):

- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 10G
- FAT: 21G
- SATURATED FAT: 3G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 24G
- FIBRE: 7G
- SUGARS: 2G
- SODIUM: 250MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 2MG

GREEK YOGURT PARFAIT WITH GRANOLA AND BERRIES

INGREDIENTS

- 200G (3/4 CUP) GREEK YOGURT (OR PLANT-BASED YOGURT)
- 2 TABLESPOONS GRANOLA
- 50G MIXED BERRIES (E.G., STRAWBERRIES, BLUEBERRIES, RASPBERRIES)
- 1 TABLESPOON HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP (OPTIONAL)
- A FEW MINT LEAVES (OPTIONAL, FOR GARNISH)

"Sweat is just fat crying."

A quick and healthy breakfast that's full of flavour and nutrients. This Greek Yogurt Parfait with Granola and Berries is packed with protein, probiotics, and antioxidants, providing a great energy boost to start your day. The crunchy granola complements the creamy yogurt and sweet berries, making it a delicious yet light breakfast.

- Spoon the Greek yogurt into a bowl or glass jar.
- Layer with granola, then top with fresh mixed berries.
- Drizzle honey or maple syrup over the top (optional).
- Garnish with fresh mint leaves, if desired.
- Serve immediately or refrigerate for later.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING)
CALORIES: 250 KCAL, PROTEIN: 12G, FAT: 8G, SATURATED FAT: 2G, CARBOHYDRATES: 28G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 15G, SODIUM: 50MG, CALCIUM: 200MG, IRON: 1MG

BANANA AND PEANUT BUTTER SMOOTHIE

INGREDIENTS

- 1 RIPE BANANA
- 1 TABLESPOON (15G) PEANUT BUTTER
- 120ML (1/2 CUP) UNSWEETENED ALMOND MILK (OR MILK OF CHOICE)
- 1 TABLESPOON (10G) HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP (OPTIONAL)
- A FEW ICE CUBES (OPTIONAL, FOR A COLDER SMOOTHIE)

"*You are what you eat, so choose wisely and fuel your greatness.*"

A creamy and filling smoothie that will keep you satisfied all morning. The banana and peanut butter blend together to create a rich, energising drink, while the protein from the peanut butter and the natural sugars from the banana provide a balanced breakfast. Perfect for a quick, on-the-go option.

- Combine the banana, peanut butter, almond milk, and honey (if using) in a blender.
- Blend until smooth and creamy.
- Add a few ice cubes for a colder smoothie, if desired.
- Pour into a glass and enjoy immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING)
CALORIES: 300 KCAL, PROTEIN: 8G, FAT: 16G, SATURATED FAT: 3G
CARBOHYDRATES: 30G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 14G, SODIUM: 120MG
CALCIUM: 100MG, IRON: 1MG

OATMEAL PANCAKES WITH BANANA AND HONEY

INGREDIENTS

- 50G (1/2 CUP) ROLLED OATS
- 1 RIPE BANANA
- 1 LARGE EGG
- 100ML (1/2 CUP) UNSWEETENED ALMOND MILK (OR ANY MILK OF CHOICE)
- 1/2 TEASPOON BAKING POWDER
- 1/4 TEASPOON CINNAMON (OPTIONAL)
- HONEY (FOR DRIZZLING, OPTIONAL)
- BERRIES (OPTIONAL)

"Nourish your body today so it can thank you tomorrow."

These oatmeal pancakes are soft, hearty, and made with wholesome ingredients. Bananas add natural sweetness, while honey gives a touch of extra sweetness. These pancakes are perfect for a satisfying breakfast that combines protein, fibre, and energy-boosting carbs.

- Blend the rolled oats in a food processor or blender until they form a fine flour.
- Add the banana, egg, almond milk, baking powder, and cinnamon (if using). Blend until smooth.
- Heat a non-stick frying pan over medium heat and lightly grease with oil or butter.
- Pour a small amount of the pancake batter onto the pan, shaping into a circle. Cook for 2-3 minutes on each side, until golden brown.
- Serve with a drizzle of honey and berries if using.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING)
CALORIES: 250 KCAL, PROTEIN: 8G, FAT: 8G, SATURATED FAT: 1G, CARBOHYDRATES: 36G, FIBRE: 5G, SUGARS: 12G, SODIUM: 60MG, CALCIUM: 150MG, IRON: 2MG

HOMEMADE GRANOLA BARS WITH OATS AND HONEY

INGREDIENTS

- 250 G (2 ½ CUPS) ROLLED OATS
- 100 G (½ CUP) HONEY
- 50 G (⅓ CUP) CHOPPED ALMONDS
- 50 G (⅓ CUP) DRIED CRANBERRIES OR RAISINS
- 50 G (¼ CUP) UNSALTED BUTTER
- 1 TSP VANILLA EXTRACT
- ½ TSP GROUND CINNAMON
- PINCH OF SALT

"*The difference between try and triumph is just a little 'umph'.*"

These Homemade Granola Bars with Oats and Honey are a nutritious, portable breakfast option or mid-morning snack. Made with rolled oats, honey, and a handful of nuts and dried fruits, these bars provide slow-releasing energy to fuel your day. Perfect for meal prep and completely customisable to suit your taste.

- Preheat your oven to 180°C (350°F). Line a 20 cm x 20 cm (8 in x 8 in) baking dish with parchment paper.
- In a saucepan, melt the butter over low heat. Stir in the honey, vanilla extract, cinnamon, and salt. Remove from heat once smooth.
- In a large bowl, combine the oats, almonds, and dried cranberries. Pour the wet mixture over the dry ingredients and mix thoroughly.
- Transfer the mixture to the prepared baking dish and press firmly into an even layer. Bake for 15-20 minutes until golden brown.
- Allow the granola to cool completely in the pan before slicing into bars. Store in an airtight container.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER BAR)
CALORIES: 200 KCAL, PROTEIN: 4 G, CARBOHYDRATES: 28 G, FAT: 8 G, FIBRE: 3 G, SUGAR: 12 G

APPLE AND ALMOND ENERGY BITES

INGREDIENTS

- 100 G (1 CUP) DRIED APPLES, FINELY CHOPPED
- 150 G (1 ½ CUPS) ROLLED OATS
- 120 G (½ CUP) ALMOND BUTTER
- 60 ML (¼ CUP) HONEY
- 1 TSP GROUND CINNAMON
- 1 TSP VANILLA EXTRACT
- PINCH OF SALT

Let food be thy medicine, and medicine be thy food." - Hippocrates

These Apple and Almond Energy Bites are the perfect grab-and-go breakfast or snack. Made with dried apples, almond butter, and oats, they're naturally sweetened and packed with protein and fibre to keep you energised. Easy to make in batches for an energy boost after training too.

- In a large bowl, mix together the oats, dried apples, almond butter, honey, cinnamon, vanilla, and salt until well combined.
- Using your hands or a small scoop, roll the mixture into small balls (about 25 g / 1 oz each).
- Place the bites on a parchment-lined tray and chill in the fridge for at least 30 minutes to firm up.
- Keep in an airtight container in the fridge for up to a week.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER BITE)

- CALORIES: 90 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 2 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 12 G
- FAT: 3.5 G
- FIBRE: 1.5 G
- SUGAR: 7 G

BACON AND EGG BREAKFAST WRAP

INGREDIENTS

- 1 LARGE WHOLE WHEAT WRAP (ABOUT 25 CM / 10 INCHES)
- 2 SLICES BACK BACON (OR STREAKY BACON), COOKED AND CHOPPED
- 2 LARGE EGGS, WHISKED
- 50 G (1.75 OZ) FRESH SPINACH
- 1 TSP OLIVE OIL
- SALT AND PEPPER, TO TASTE

"It's not about being the best; it's about being better than you were yesterday."

This Bacon and Egg Breakfast Wrap is a simple yet satisfying way to start your day. Combining crispy bacon, fluffy scrambled eggs, and fresh spinach in a whole wheat wrap, this hearty breakfast is a great on-the-go option that provides protein and flavour.

- Fry the bacon in a non-stick pan over medium heat until crispy. Remove and set aside.
- In the same pan, add the spinach and cook for 1-2 minutes until wilted. Remove and set aside.
- Add the olive oil to the pan and pour in the whisked eggs. Cook over low heat, stirring gently until the eggs are fluffy and cooked through. Season with salt and pepper.
- Lay the whole wheat wrap flat. Add the scrambled eggs, spinach, and bacon in the centre. Fold in the sides and roll tightly.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER WRAP)

- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 20 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 28 G
- FAT: 12 G
- FIBRE: 5 G
- SUGAR: 2 G

EASY BREAKFAST EGG MUFFIN CUPS

INGREDIENTS

- 6 LARGE EGGS
- 50 G (1.75 OZ) GRATED CHEDDAR CHEESE
- 50 G (1.75 OZ) DICED RED BELL PEPPER
- 50 G (1.75 OZ) FRESH SPINACH, CHOPPED
- 1 TSP OLIVE OIL
- SALT AND PEPPER, TO TASTE
- OPTIONAL - A COUPLE OF SPRING ONIONS (SCALLIONS) CHOPPED AND ADDED.

"Good nutrition creates health in all areas of our existence."

These Easy Breakfast Egg Muffin Cups are a versatile and nutritious breakfast option. Made with eggs, vegetables, and cheese, these muffin-shaped bites are low-carb and great for meal prep. Customise with your favourite ingredients for a convenient grab-and-go breakfast!

- Preheat your oven to 180°C (350°F). Lightly grease a 6-cup muffin tin with olive oil.
- In a bowl, whisk the eggs with salt and pepper. Stir in the cheddar cheese, bell pepper, and spinach.
- Pour the mixture evenly into the prepared muffin cups, filling them about three-quarters full.
- Place in the oven and bake for 20-25 minutes, or until the eggs are set and lightly golden on top.
- Let cool slightly before removing from the tin. Store in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 4 days. But I love them warm!!

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER MUFFIN)

- CALORIES: 100 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 7 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 2 G
- FAT: 7 G
- FIBRE: 0.5 G
- SUGAR: 1 G

LUNCH IDEAS

Lunch was where it often went wrong in my previous attempts with weight loss. Temptation got the better of me. Sandwiches, crisps, chocolate bar, latte and juice. It was surprising how much I was eating, and most of it was what I call "hollow calories." To me, a lot of this food has calories but it does not fill you up and keep you going. Salads became an obvious choice for me, and I have tried not to put too many of them in this booklet. However even now a salad has the ability to fill me up if there is plenty of it, with different textures and variety. A limp bit of lettuce, tomato and cucumber just isn't going to cut it with me. So I hope some of the suggestions here will help.

HAM, SPINACH, AND MUSHROOM OMELETTE

INGREDIENTS

- 2 LARGE EGGS
- 2 SLICES HAM, CHOPPED
- 50G FRESH SPINACH
- 50G MUSHROOMS, SLICED
- 1 TEASPOON OLIVE OIL (FOR COOKING)
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE

"*Strong is the new skinny.*"

A simple and nutritious lunch option, this Ham, Spinach, and Mushroom Omelette is quick to make and packed with protein. The earthy mushrooms and fresh spinach pair beautifully with the savoury ham, making this dish both filling and energising. Perfect for a light but satisfying midday meal.

- Heat the olive oil in a frying pan over medium heat.
- Add the chopped ham and cook for 2-3 minutes, until slightly crispy.
- Add the sliced mushrooms and spinach, cooking for another 2-3 minutes until the spinach wilts and the mushrooms soften.
- In a bowl, whisk the eggs with salt and pepper, then pour them into the pan over the ham, spinach, and mushrooms.
- Cook for 3-4 minutes until the eggs are set, then fold the omelette in half and serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER OMELETTE)

- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 26G
- FAT: 18G, SATURATED FAT: 5G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 6G
- FIBRE: 2G, SUGARS: 3G
- SODIUM: 450MG, CALCIUM: 100MG
- IRON: 2MG

TUNA NIÇOISE SALAD

INGREDIENTS

- 300 G (2 CUPS) NEW POTATOES, HALVED
- 200 G (2 CUPS) GREEN BEANS, TRIMMED
- 2 LARGE EGGS
- 150 G (1 TIN / 5 OZ) TUNA IN SPRING WATER, DRAINED
- 100 G (3 CUPS) MIXED SALAD GREENS
- 6 CHERRY TOMATOES, HALVED
- 30 G (¼ CUP) BLACK OLIVES, PITTED AND SLICED
- 2 TBSP EXTRA VIRGIN OLIVE OIL
- 1 TBSP WHITE WINE VINEGAR
- 1 TSP DIJON MUSTARD
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE

"Healthy eating is a form of self-respect."

This Tuna Niçoise Salad is a classic, protein-packed dish that's perfect for a light yet satisfying lunch. Made with tender new potatoes, crisp green beans, and hard-boiled eggs, it's elevated by the bold flavour of tuna and a zesty vinaigrette. Perfect for meal prep or a quick, healthy meal.

- Place the new potatoes in a saucepan of salted boiling water. Cook for 10-12 minutes until tender. Drain and set aside to cool.
- In the same pot, bring fresh water to a boil. Add the green beans and cook for 2-3 minutes until tender-crisp. Drain and rinse under cold water to stop the cooking process.
- In a separate saucepan, place the eggs in boiling water and cook for 8-10 minutes. Cool under running cold water, peel, and cut into halves.
- On a large plate or bowl, arrange the mixed greens as a base. Top with potatoes, green beans, tuna, cherry tomatoes, olives, and egg halves.
- Whisk together the olive oil, white wine vinegar, Dijon mustard, salt, and pepper in a small bowl. Drizzle the dressing over the salad and serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING)

- CALORIES: 350 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 25 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 20 G
- FAT: 18 G
- FIBRE: 5 G
- SUGAR: 4 G

TUNA AND TOMATO PASTA

INGREDIENTS

- 150G (1 1/2 CUPS) WHOLE WHEAT PASTA
- 1 CAN (150G) TUNA IN OIL, DRAINED
- 150G CHERRY TOMATOES
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 1/2 TEASPOON DRIED OREGANO
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- FRESH BASIL FOR GARNISH (OPTIONAL)

"Wake up, work out, and conquer the day."

This Tuna and Tomato Pasta is a quick and delicious lunch option. The combination of flaky tuna and juicy tomatoes in a light pasta sauce makes this dish both comforting and nutritious. With plenty of protein and fibre, it's a great choice for an energy-boosting meal.

- Cook the whole wheat pasta according to package instructions.
- While the pasta is cooking, heat the olive oil in a pan over medium heat.
- Add the cherry tomatoes and cook for 3-4 minutes until softened.
- Add the drained tuna to the pan, breaking it up with a spoon.
- Season with dried oregano, salt, and pepper.
- Once the pasta is cooked, drain and add it to the pan with the tuna and tomatoes.
- Toss everything together and serve with fresh basil if desired.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 400 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 25G
- FAT: 12G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 50G, FIBRE: 6G, SUGARS: 6G
- SODIUM: 300MG
- CALCIUM: 60MG
- IRON: 3MG

LENTIL AND VEGETABLE SOUP

INGREDIENTS

- 100G (1/2 CUP) DRY LENTILS, RINSED
- 1 CARROT, DICED
- 1 CELERY STALK, DICED
- 1 ONION, CHOPPED
- 1 CLOVE GARLIC, MINCED
- 400G CANNED DICED TOMATOES
- 750ML VEGETABLE BROTH
- 1 TEASPOON DRIED THYME
- 1 TEASPOON CUMIN
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- A SPRIG OF FRESH THYME TO DECORATE (OPTIONAL)

"The best investment you'll ever make is in your health."

This hearty Lentil and Vegetable Soup is perfect for a nutritious and filling lunch. Packed with lentils, vegetables, and a variety of herbs, it's a great source of plant-based protein and fibre. Ideal for warming up on a chilly day.

- Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat.
- Add the onion, carrot, celery, and garlic, cooking for 5 minutes until softened.
- Add the tomatoes, lentils, broth, thyme, cumin, salt, and pepper.
- Bring the soup to a boil, then reduce the heat to low and simmer for 25-30 minutes, until the lentils are tender.
- Serve hot.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 250 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 12G
- FAT: 5G, SATURATED FAT: 1G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 40G, FIBRE: ~14G, SUGARS: 8G
- SODIUM: 700MG
- CALCIUM: 60MG
- IRON: 3MG

TURKEY AND HUMMUS ROLL-UPS

INGREDIENTS

- 4 SLICES OF TURKEY BREAST (PREFERABLY NITRATE-FREE)
- 2 TABLESPOONS HUMMUS
- 1/2 CUCUMBER, THINLY SLICED
- 1/4 BELL PEPPER, THINLY SLICED
- 1/4 AVOCADO, SLICED
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE

"A one-hour workout is just 4% of your day."

These Turkey and Hummus Roll-Ups are a great high-protein, low-carb lunch option. Sliced turkey breast is spread with creamy hummus and rolled up with crisp veggies, making it an easy, satisfying, and portable meal.

- Lay the turkey slices flat on a clean surface.
- Spread hummus evenly over each slice.
- Layer with cucumber, bell pepper, and avocado slices.
- Roll up the turkey slices tightly and slice into bite-sized pieces.
- Season with salt and pepper, and serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 1

- CALORIES: 250 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 20G
- FAT: 18G, SATURATED FAT: ~3G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 6G, FIBRE: 3G, SUGARS: 2G
- SODIUM: 600MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 2MG

GRILLED SALMON SALAD WITH MIXED GREENS

INGREDIENTS

- 150G SALMON FILLET
- 100G MIXED SALAD GREENS
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 1 TEASPOON LEMON JUICE
- 1/4 AVOCADO, SLICED
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE

"Don't count calories; make calories count."

This Grilled Salmon Salad with Mixed Greens is a protein-packed, light, and nutritious lunch. The richness of the grilled salmon pairs perfectly with the fresh greens, making this dish a balanced and delicious meal.

- Preheat the grill or grill pan over medium heat.
- Season the salmon fillet with salt, pepper, and a little olive oil.
- Grill the salmon for 4-5 minutes on each side, until cooked through.
- Toss the mixed greens with olive oil and lemon juice.
- Place the grilled salmon on top of the salad, and garnish with avocado slices.
- Serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 1

- CALORIES: 350 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 30G
- FAT: 22G, SATURATED FAT: 3G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 6G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 2G
- SODIUM: 300MG
- CALCIUM: 50MG
- IRON: 2MG

CREAMY EGG SALAD SANDWICH WITH AVOCADO AND WHOLE GRAIN BREAD

INGREDIENTS

- 4 BOILED EGGS, CHOPPED
- 1/2 AVOCADO, MASHED
- 1-2 SPRING ONIONS (SCALLIONS) D=FINELY SLICED
- 1 TABLESPOON PLAIN GREEK YOGHURT
- 1 TEASPOON DIJON MUSTARD
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- 2 SLICES WHOLE GRAIN BREAD
- OPTIONAL A SPRINKLING OF CAYENNE PEPPER

"Push yourself because no one else is going to do it for you."

A deliciously creamy yet healthy egg salad sandwich made with mashed avocado and whole grain bread. This is a tasty and satisfying lunch option that combines protein, healthy fats, and fibre.

- In a bowl, combine the chopped eggs, mashed avocado, Greek yoghurt, and Dijon mustard.
- Season with salt and pepper and mix well.
- Spread the egg salad mixture onto the slices of whole grain bread, then sprinkle the spring onions over the top.
- Serve immediately or wrap for later.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 1

- CALORIES: 400 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 20G
- FAT: 25G, SATURATED FAT: 5G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 30G, FIBRE: 6G, SUGARS: 3G
- SODIUM: 450MG
- CALCIUM: 70MG
- IRON: 3MG

HEARTY TOMATO AND LENTIL SOUP

INGREDIENTS

- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 1 MEDIUM ONION, FINELY CHOPPED
- 2 GARLIC CLOVES, MINCED
- 2 MEDIUM CARROTS, DICED
- 400 G (14 OZ) CANNED CHOPPED TOMATOES
- 150 G (¾ CUP) RED LENTILS, RINSED
- 750 ML (3 CUPS) VEGETABLE STOCK
- 1 TSP DRIED THYME
- 1 TSP PAPRIKA
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE
- OPTIONAL: FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED (FOR GARNISH)

"*Healthy eating is a journey, not a punishment.*"

This Hearty Tomato and Lentil Soup is a comforting, nutritious, and easy-to-make lunch option. Packed with protein-rich lentils and vibrant tomatoes, it's perfect for staying full and energised throughout the day. Pair it with crusty whole grain bread for an even heartier meal.

- Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion, garlic, and carrots. Cook for 5-7 minutes until softened.
- Stir in the canned tomatoes and rinsed red lentils. Cook for 2 minutes to combine flavours.
- Pour in the vegetable stock. Add thyme, paprika, salt, and pepper. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer. Cover and cook for 20-25 minutes until the lentils are tender.
- For a smoother texture, use an blender to partially blend the soup.
- Ladle the soup into bowls. Garnish with fresh parsley, if desired, and serve hot with whole grain bread.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 250 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 12 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 35 G
- FAT: 5 G
- FIBRE: 10 G
- SUGAR: 10 G

BAKED FALAFEL WITH A SIMPLE TAHINI SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

- 400G CAN OF CHICKPEAS, DRAINED AND RINSED
- 1 SMALL ONION, CHOPPED
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 1/2 TEASPOON CUMIN
- 1/2 TEASPOON GROUND CORIANDER
- 1/2 TEASPOON PAPRIKA
- 2 TABLESPOONS FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED
- 2 TABLESPOONS OLIVE OIL
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- 1 TABLESPOON WHOLE WHEAT FLOUR
- **FOR THE TAHINI SAUCE:**
- 2 TABLESPOONS TAHINI
- 1 TABLESPOON LEMON JUICE
- 1 TABLESPOON WATER
- 1 TEASPOON OLIVE OIL

"*It never gets easier; you just get stronger.*"

Baked Falafel with a simple tahini sauce makes a healthy, crunchy lunch packed with plant-based protein and fibre. These crispy chickpea balls are served with a creamy tahini dressing, making them a perfect meal for a nutritious and filling lunch.

- Preheat the oven to 200°C (180°C fan)/400°F.
- In a food processor, combine chickpeas, onion, garlic, cumin, coriander, paprika, parsley, olive oil, salt, and pepper. Process until a coarse dough forms.
- Add the flour and pulse to combine.
- Form the mixture into small balls and place them on a lined baking tray.
- Bake for 20-25 minutes, flipping halfway through, until golden and crispy.
- For the tahini sauce, mix tahini, lemon juice, water, and olive oil together until smooth.
- Serve the falafel with the tahini sauce.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 350 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 12G
- FAT: 15G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 40G, FIBRE: 10G, SUGARS: 5G
- SODIUM: 400MG
- CALCIUM: 60MG
- IRON: 4MG

MEDITERRANEAN QUINOA SALAD

INGREDIENTS

- 120 G (¾ CUP) QUINOA, RINSED
- 240 ML (1 CUP) WATER
- 100 G (1 CUP) CHERRY TOMATOES, HALVED
- 1 SMALL CUCUMBER, DICED
- 50 G (¼ CUP) RED ONION, FINELY CHOPPED
- 50 G (¼ CUP) FETA CHEESE, CRUMBLED
- 50 G (¼ CUP) BLACK OLIVES, SLICED
- 2 TBSP FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED
- 1 TBSP FRESH MINT, CHOPPED (OPTIONAL)
- **FOR THE DRESSING:**
- 2 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 1 TBSP LEMON JUICE
- 1 TSP RED WINE VINEGAR
- ½ TSP DRIED OREGANO
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE

"*Eat less from a box and more from the earth.*"

This Mediterranean Quinoa Salad is a vibrant and nutritious lunch option. It combines fluffy quinoa, fresh vegetables, and a tangy dressing for a light yet satisfying meal. High in protein and fibre, it's ideal for meal prep or a quick weekday lunch.

- Place the rinsed quinoa and water in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer. Cover and cook for 15 minutes or until the water is absorbed. Fluff with a fork and let it cool.
- While the quinoa cools, chop the cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red onion, parsley, and mint (if using). Set aside.
- In a small bowl, whisk together olive oil, lemon juice, red wine vinegar, dried oregano, salt, and pepper.
- In a large bowl, combine the cooked quinoa, chopped vegetables, olives, and feta cheese. Pour the dressing over the salad and toss until evenly coated.
- Garnish with extra parsley if desired and serve immediately. Store leftovers in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 3 days.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 1

- CALORIES: 290 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 9 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 26 G
- FAT: 15 G
- FIBRE: 4 G
- SUGAR: 4 G

DINNER IDEAS

Dinner can be a difficult meal for people, in that to stay consistent, you have to resist temptation. After a hard days work, the lure of comfort food and using convenience or take out, can soon set you back and undo all the hard work. This was where having a list of recipes made my life easier. I could plan more and make the meals more than just salad and a jacket potato. Although my love for a jacket potato, will never cease, it is nice to have a few options. Plus ones that other people may enjoy too. Most of these dishes serve two. So if you need to feed more then just double up the recipe.

ONE-POT SKILLET CHICKEN AND VEGETABLES

INGREDIENTS

- 2 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 500 G (1 LB) CHICKEN BREAST OR THIGHS, CUT INTO BITE-SIZED PIECES
- 1 RED BELL PEPPER, DICED
- 1 YELLOW BELL PEPPER, DICED
- 150 G (1 CUP) CHERRY TOMATOES, HALVED
- 100 G (2 CUPS) FRESH SPINACH
- 3 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 1 TSP DRIED OREGANO
- 1 TSP SMOKED PAPRIKA
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE
- 60 ML (¼ CUP) CHICKEN STOCK OR WATER
- JUICE OF ½ A LEMON
- FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED, FOR GARNISH
- OPTIONAL 150 G (1 CUP) FROZEN PEAS

"*What seems impossible today will soon become your warm-up.*"

This One-Pot Skillet Chicken and Vegetables is a wholesome and convenient meal that's perfect for busy weeknights. Packed with lean chicken, colourful vegetables, and simple seasonings, it's cooked entirely in one skillet for easy cleanup. A balanced dish that's high in protein and loaded with nutrients.

- Heat 1 tbsp olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add the chicken pieces, season with salt and pepper, and cook for 6-8 minutes until golden and cooked through. Remove the chicken from the pan and set aside.
- Add the remaining olive oil to the skillet. Add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds until fragrant. Add the bell peppers and cook for 4-5 minutes, stirring occasionally, until slightly softened.
- Stir in the cherry tomatoes and cook for 2 minutes. Add the spinach and cook until wilted.
- Return the cooked chicken to the skillet, along with frozen peas if using. Sprinkle with oregano, smoked paprika, and a little more salt and pepper. Pour in the chicken stock or water and stir everything together. Reduce the heat to low, cover, and simmer for 5 minutes.
- Remove the lid and squeeze lemon juice over the dish. Stir well, garnish with fresh parsley, and serve hot.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 320 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 36 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 10 G
- FAT: 14 G
- FIBRE: 4 G
- SUGAR: 6 G

BAKED SWEET POTATO COTTAGE PIE

INGREDIENTS

- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 500 G (1 LB) LEAN GROUND BEEF OR TURKEY
- 1 MEDIUM ONION, DICED
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 2 MEDIUM CARROTS, DICED
- 1 MEDIUM ZUCCHINI (COURGETTE) SLICED
- 150 G (1 CUP) FROZEN PEAS
- 2 TBSP TOMATO PASTE
- 1 TSP DRIED THYME
- 1 TSP DRIED ROSEMARY
- 250 ML (1 CUP) BEEF OR CHICKEN STOCK
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE
- **FOR THE SWEET POTATO MASH:**
- 800 G (1.75 LBS) SWEET POTATOES, PEELED AND CUBED
- 2 TBSP MILK (OR PLANT-BASED MILK FOR DAIRY-FREE)
- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL OR BUTTER
- PINCH OF SALT

"Take care of your body; it's the only place you have to live."

This Baked Sweet Potato Cottage Pie is a lighter version of the classic comfort food. Featuring lean ground beef or turkey, hearty vegetables, and a creamy sweet potato topping, it's a nutritious and satisfying dinner option that's easy to make and packed with flavour.

- Place the sweet potato cubes in a pot of salted water. Bring to a boil and cook for 10-15 minutes until tender.
- Drain and mash the sweet potatoes. Stir in the milk, olive oil or butter, and a pinch of salt. Set aside.
- Preheat the oven to 190°C (375°F).
- Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, and sauté for 2-3 minutes until softened.
- Add the ground meat and cook until browned, breaking it up with a spoon.
- Stir in the carrots, zucchini, and tomato paste. Cook for another 3-4 minutes.
- Add the dried thyme, rosemary, stock, and frozen peas. Simmer for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the mixture thickens slightly. Season with salt and pepper.
- Transfer the filling to a baking dish (approximately 20 x 20 cm or 8 x 8 inches). Spread the sweet potato mash evenly on top. Use a fork to create a textured pattern.
- Place the dish in the preheated oven and bake for 20-25 minutes, or until the top is slightly golden.
- Let cool for 5 minutes before serving.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 340 KCAL, PROTEIN: 23 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 32 G, FAT: 12 G, FIBRE: 6 G, SUGAR: 8 G

SALMON AND VEGETABLE CASSEROLE

INGREDIENTS

- 2 SALMON FILLETS (150G EACH)
- 200G BROCCOLI, CHOPPED (SOMETIMES I SWAP FOR MY FAVOURITE ASPARAGUS WHEN IN SEASON)
- 1 GREEN BELL PEPPER, CHOPPED
- 1 ZUCCHINI, SLICED
- 125 G (1/2 CUP) CREAM CHEESE
- 60 ML (1/4 CUP) MILK OR PLANT-BASED MILK
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 1 TEASPOON DRIED THYME
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- OPTIONAL LEMON SLICES

"The body achieves what the mind believes."

This Salmon and Vegetable Casserole is a comforting yet nutritious dinner option. It's made with tender salmon fillets, baked with a medley of vegetables and a creamy sauce. The perfect dinner for a balanced, omega-3 rich meal.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (160°C fan)/350°F.
- In a pan, heat olive oil over medium heat and sauté the bell pepper and zucchini until softened (about 5 minutes).
- Stir in the broccoli and cook for another 2 minutes.
- In a bowl, mix the cream cheese with the milk, thyme, salt, and pepper.
- Place the sautéed vegetables in a baking dish, and top with the salmon fillets.
- Pour the creamy sauce over the salmon and vegetables. I also like to add in some chunky lemon slices. This is optional as I know some who like it with and some who do not.
- Bake for 20-25 minutes, until the salmon is cooked through and flakes easily.
- Serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 400 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 30G
- FAT: 25G SATURATED FAT: 5G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 15G FIBRE: 5G SUGARS: 5G
- SODIUM: 300MG
- CALCIUM: 120MG
- IRON: 2MG

BAKED HERB AND LEMON CHICKEN DRUMSTICKS

INGREDIENTS

- 1 KG (2.2 LBS) CHICKEN DRUMSTICKS OR THIGHS, SKIN ON OR OFF AS PREFERRED
- 3 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 2 TBSP FRESH PARSLEY, FINELY CHOPPED
- 1 TBSP FRESH ROSEMARY, FINELY CHOPPED
- 1 TBSP FRESH THYME, FINELY CHOPPED
- 1 TSP DRIED OREGANO
- JUICE AND ZEST OF 1 LEMON
- 1/2 TSP SALT
- 1/2 TSP BLACK PEPPER

"*Healthy food fuels a healthy life.*"

This Baked Herb and Lemon Chicken Drumsticks recipe is a simple, healthy, and flavour-packed dish. Perfectly seasoned with fresh herbs, garlic, and zesty lemon, it's a versatile choice for lunch or dinner. Serve with roasted vegetables, a salad, or quinoa for a balanced meal.

- Preheat your oven to 200°C (400°F) and line a baking tray with parchment paper or foil.
- In a large bowl, mix olive oil, garlic, parsley, rosemary, thyme, oregano, lemon juice, lemon zest, salt, and black pepper.
- Add the chicken drumsticks or thighs to the bowl, ensuring they are evenly coated with the marinade. Cover and let them marinate for at least 30 minutes, or up to 2 hours in the fridge for deeper flavour.
- Arrange the marinated chicken pieces on the prepared baking tray. Bake for 35-40 minutes, turning halfway through, until golden brown and cooked through (internal temperature should reach 75°C / 165°F).
- Let the chicken rest for 5 minutes before serving. Garnish with extra fresh parsley and serve with your choice of sides.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 4

- CALORIES: 280 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 26 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 2 G
- FAT: 18 G
- FIBRE: 0 G
- SUGAR: 0 G

LENTIL AND CHICKPEA CURRY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 1 ONION, CHOPPED
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 1 CARROT, DICED
- 1 CAN (400G) CHICKPEAS, DRAINED AND RINSED
- 100G DRIED RED LENTILS
- 1 CAN (400G) CHOPPED TOMATOES
- 200ML COCONUT MILK
- 1 TABLESPOON CURRY POWDER
- 1 TEASPOON GROUND CUMIN
- 1 TEASPOON TURMERIC
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- FRESH CORIANDER FOR GARNISH AND FRESH CHILLI SLICES (OPTIONAL)

"Motivation gets you started; habit keeps you going."

This Lentil and Chickpea Curry is a hearty, plant-based dish packed with protein and fibre. The lentils and chickpeas are simmered in a fragrant curry sauce made with spices, tomatoes, and coconut milk. It's a nutritious, satisfying, and easy-to-make dinner.

- In a large pan, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic and sauté until softened, about 3-4 minutes.
- Add the carrot, chickpeas, and lentils. Stir for 2 minutes.
- Stir in the curry powder, cumin, turmeric, salt, and pepper.
- Pour in the chopped tomatoes and coconut milk. Bring to a simmer.
- Cook for 25-30 minutes, or until the lentils are tender and the curry has thickened.
- Garnish with fresh coriander and serve.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2-3

- CALORIES: 350 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 20G
- FAT: 15G, SATURATED FAT: 6G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 40G, FIBRE: 12G, SUGARS: 8G
- SODIUM: 400MG
- CALCIUM: 60MG
- IRON: 4MG

CHICKEN AND VEGETABLE STIR-FRY

INGREDIENTS

- FOR THE STIR-FRY:
- 2 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 2 CHICKEN BREASTS (ABOUT 300 G / 10 OZ), CUT INTO THIN STRIPS
- 1 MEDIUM ONION, SLICED
- 2 MEDIUM CARROTS, SLICED INTO THIN MATCHSTICKS
- 1 RED BELL PEPPER, SLICED INTO THIN STRIPS
- 1 MEDIUM BROCCOLI HEAD, CUT INTO SMALL FLORETS (ABOUT 250 G / 9 OZ)
- 100 G (3.5 OZ) SNAP PEAS OR GREEN BEANS, TRIMMED
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- 1 TSP FRESH GINGER, GRATED
- FOR THE SAUCE:
- 3 TBSP SOY SAUCE (OR TAMARI FOR GLUTEN-FREE)
- 1 TBSP SESAME OIL
- 2 TBSP HONEY
- 2 TBSP WATER
- 1 TBSP CORNSTARCH

"A colourful plate is a healthy plate."

This Chicken and Vegetable Stir-Fry is a quick and healthy one-pan dish perfect for busy days. Packed with lean chicken, colourful veggies, and a savoury sauce, it's a simple and balanced meal. Serve with brown rice, noodles, or enjoy on its own for a low-carb option.

- In a small bowl, whisk together soy sauce, sesame oil, honey, water, and cornstarch. Set aside.
- Heat 1 tbsp of olive oil in a large frying pan or wok over medium-high heat. Add the chicken strips and stir-fry for 4-5 minutes, until fully cooked. Remove the chicken and set aside.
- Add the remaining 1 tbsp olive oil to the pan. Stir-fry the onion, garlic, and ginger for 1 minute. Add the carrots, bell pepper, broccoli, and snap peas. Cook for 5-6 minutes, stirring frequently, until the vegetables are tender but still crisp.
- Return the chicken to the pan with the vegetables. Pour the sauce over the mixture and stir well. Cook for 2-3 minutes, allowing the sauce to thicken and coat the chicken and veggies evenly.
- Serve the stir-fry hot, either on its own or over cooked brown rice or noodles.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 310 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 28 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 18 G
- FAT: 12 G
- FIBRE: 4 G
- SUGAR: 9 G

CAULIFLOWER AND BROCCOLI CHEESE BAKE

INGREDIENTS

- 200G CAULIFLOWER, CHOPPED
- 200G BROCCOLI, CHOPPED
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 50 G (1/2 CUP) GRATED CHEESE
- 60 ML (1/4 CUP) MILK (OR PLANT-BASED MILK)
- 1 TABLESPOON FLOUR
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- FRESH THYME FOR GARNISH (OPTIONAL)

"Stop waiting for Monday, start today."

This Cauliflower and Broccoli Cheese Bake is a low-carb, cheesy comfort food option. The cauliflower and broccoli are baked in a creamy, cheesy sauce, making this a satisfying, nutritious dinner that is both filling and healthy.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (160°C fan)/350°F.
- Steam the cauliflower and broccoli until tender, about 5-7 minutes.
- In a small saucepan, heat olive oil and stir in the flour. Cook for 1-2 minutes to form a roux.
- Gradually whisk in the milk, cooking until thickened.
- Stir in the cheese, salt, and pepper, and cook until the cheese melts.
- Place the steamed vegetables in a baking dish and pour the cheese sauce over them.
- Bake for 15-20 minutes until golden and bubbly.
- Garnish with fresh thyme and serve.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 12G
- FAT: 20G, SATURATED FAT: 8G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 20G, FIBRE: ~8, SUGARS: ~5G
- SODIUM: ~400MG
- CALCIUM: ~200MG
- IRON: ~3MG

COURGETTE AND MUSHROOM PASTA WITH GARLIC AND OLIVE OIL

INGREDIENTS

- 150G WHOLE WHEAT PASTA
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- 1 COURGETTE, SLICED
- 100G MUSHROOMS, SLICED
- 2 CLOVES GARLIC, MINCED
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE
- FRESH PARSLEY FOR GARNISH (OPTIONAL)

"The fresher the food, the better the mood."

This Courgette and Mushroom Pasta with Garlic and Olive Oil is a light and flavourful dinner. The courgette adds freshness, the mushrooms provide depth, and garlic and olive oil bring it all together in a simple yet satisfying dish. Perfect for those looking for a low-calorie, healthy pasta meal.

- Cook the whole wheat pasta according to package instructions. Drain and set aside.
- Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add the garlic and sauté for 1 minute.
- Add the courgette and mushrooms, and cook for 5-7 minutes, until the vegetables are tender.
- Toss the cooked pasta with the vegetable mixture, season with salt and pepper, and cook for an additional 2-3 minutes.
- Garnish with fresh parsley and serve.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING):
- CALORIES: 300 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 10G
- FAT: 12G, SATURATED FAT: 1G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 35G, FIBRE: 7G, SUGARS: 6G
- SODIUM: 300MG
- CALCIUM: 40MG
- IRON: 2MG

HEALTHY FILLET STEAK WITH ROASTED VEGETABLES

INGREDIENTS

- 2 X 150 G (5.3 OZ) FILLET STEAKS (ABOUT 1.5 CM / 1/2 INCH THICK)
- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE
- 1 TSP FRESH THYME LEAVES (OR 1/2 TSP DRIED THYME)
- 1 MEDIUM SWEET POTATO, PEELED AND CUBED
- 1/2 RED ONION, CUT INTO WEDGES
- 1/2 RED BELL PEPPER, SLICED
- 1 ZUCCHINI (COURGETTE), SLICED
- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL (FOR THE VEGETABLES)
- 1 TSP DRIED OREGANO
- FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED (FOR GARNISH)

"*Train insane or remain the same.*"

This Healthy Fillet Steak with Roasted Vegetables is a perfect balance of lean protein and nutrient-packed vegetables. The fillet steak is pan-seared to perfection, and the roasted vegetables bring a lovely natural sweetness and texture to the dish. It's an elegant and satisfying meal for a healthier take on steak dinner.

- Preheat the oven to 200°C (400°F). Place the cubed sweet potato, red onion wedges, red bell pepper, and zucchini slices onto a baking tray. Drizzle with 1 tbsp olive oil, then sprinkle with dried oregano, salt, and pepper. Toss well to coat. Roast in the oven for 25-30 minutes, or until the vegetables are tender and slightly caramelised.
- While the vegetables are roasting, heat 1 tbsp olive oil in a large frying pan over medium-high heat. Season the fillet steaks with salt, black pepper, and fresh thyme. Once the pan is hot, add the steaks and cook for 3-4 minutes on each side (for medium-rare), or longer if you prefer your steak more done. Remove the steaks from the pan and let them rest for 5 minutes.
- Plate the roasted vegetables alongside the fillet steaks. Garnish with chopped fresh parsley for a burst of colour and freshness.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 450 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 35 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 32 G
- FAT: 22 G
- FIBRE: 6 G
- SUGAR: 10 G

HEALTHY VEGETABLE AND CHEDDAR FRITTATA

INGREDIENTS

- 6 LARGE EGGS
- 100 G (3.5 OZ) MATURE CHEDDAR CHEESE, GRATED
- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 1 SMALL ONION, CHOPPED
- 1 RED BELL PEPPER, DICED
- 1 ZUCCHINI (COURGETTE), SLICED
- 100 G (3.5 OZ) SPINACH LEAVES, FRESH OR FROZEN
- 1/2 TSP DRIED OREGANO
- SALT AND BLACK PEPPER, TO TASTE
- FRESH PARSLEY, CHOPPED (FOR GARNISH)

"If you keep good food in your fridge, you'll eat good food."

This Healthy Vegetable and Cheddar Frittata is a delicious, low-carb meal filled with vegetables and packed with protein from the eggs. The sharp cheddar cheese adds a nice flavour, while the eggs provide the perfect base to hold the veggies together. It's a nutritious dinner, lunch, or even a hearty breakfast!

- Preheat your oven to 180°C (350°F).
- Heat the olive oil in a large, oven-proof frying pan over medium heat. Add the onion, red bell pepper, and zucchini. Cook for 5-7 minutes until the vegetables soften and begin to brown slightly. Add the spinach and cook for an additional 2 minutes until wilted (if using frozen spinach, allow it to thaw and cook through).
- In a bowl, whisk the eggs with the dried oregano, salt, and pepper. Add the grated cheddar cheese and mix to combine.
- Pour the egg mixture over the cooked vegetables in the frying pan. Stir gently to distribute the vegetables evenly. Allow the frittata to cook on the stove for 3-4 minutes until the edges start to set.
- Transfer the frying pan to the preheated oven and bake for 10-12 minutes, or until the frittata is fully set and golden on top.
- Remove the frittata from the oven and let it cool for a couple of minutes. Slice into wedges and garnish with fresh parsley before serving.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 260 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 18 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 8 G
- FAT: 20 G
- FIBRE: 3 G
- SUGAR: 5 G

DESSERT IDEAS

Dessert is what can make people crack under pressure. There is nothing worse than watching people devour your favourite puddings in front of you. What I would say, is not to deprive yourself of an occasional treat. Life is too short. One pudding here and there is not what got me overweight. It was lack of movement and too much food both healthy and unhealthy. However, I did put together a few dessert dishes to help my cravings. One tip I can give you, is that when I truly craved chocolate, I would have 3 squares of dark chocolate (the 70% cocoa or higher variety). It did take the edge off the craving. It may not be like milk chocolate, but it is something!

CHIA SEED PUDDING WITH BERRIES

INGREDIENTS

- 30G CHIA SEEDS
- 250ML ALMOND MILK (OR ANY MILK OF CHOICE)
- 1 TABLESPOON HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP
- 1/2 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT
- 100G MIXED BERRIES (STRAWBERRIES, BLUEBERRIES, RASPBERRIES)

"You don't find time to exercise; you make time."

This Chia Seed Pudding with Berries is a quick, easy, and healthy dessert. Packed with fibre, antioxidants, and healthy fats, it's a perfect treat for anyone looking for a light yet satisfying dessert. Top it off with fresh berries for added flavour and nutrients.

- In a bowl, combine chia seeds, almond milk, honey (or maple syrup), and vanilla extract.
- Stir well and let sit for 5 minutes. Stir again to prevent clumping.
- Cover and refrigerate for at least 2 hours or overnight.
- Before serving, top with fresh berries.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 1

- CALORIES: 180 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 4G
- FAT: 12G, SATURATED FAT: 1G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 14G, FIBRE: 8G, SUGARS: 7G
- SODIUM: 20MG
- CALCIUM: 40MG
- IRON: 3MG

HEALTHY CARROT CAKE WITH WHOLE WHEAT FLOUR AND GREEK YOGURT FROSTING

INGREDIENTS

- 200G WHOLE WHEAT FLOUR
- 1 TEASPOON BAKING POWDER
- 1/2 TEASPOON BAKING SODA
- 1/2 TEASPOON GROUND CINNAMON
- 1/4 TEASPOON GROUND NUTMEG
- 1/4 TEASPOON SALT
- 3 LARGE EGGS
- 120ML OLIVE OIL
- 100G HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP
- 250G GRATED CARROTS
- 1 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT
- 100G CHOPPED WALNUTS (OPTIONAL)
- FROSTING:
- 150G GREEK YOGURT
- 1 TABLESPOON HONEY
- 1/2 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT

"Think of healthy eating as a lifestyle, not a diet."

This healthier version of carrot cake is made with whole wheat flour and topped with a creamy Greek yogurt frosting. It's lower in sugar but still full of the rich, spiced flavour you expect from a traditional carrot cake.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (350°F). Grease and line a round cake tin.
- In a large bowl, combine the flour, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt.
- In another bowl, whisk together the eggs, olive oil, honey (or maple syrup), vanilla extract, and grated carrots.
- Fold the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients and mix until just combined.
- Stir in the walnuts (if using).
- Pour the batter into the prepared tin and bake for 30-35 minutes, or until a skewer comes out clean.
- Allow the cake to cool completely.
- For the frosting, mix Greek yogurt, honey, and vanilla extract together and spread over the cooled cake.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 250 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 6G
- FAT: 18G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 25G, FIBRE: 3G, SUGARS: 15G
- SODIUM: 120MG
- CALCIUM: 40MG
- IRON: 2MG

BAKED APPLES WITH CINNAMON AND WALNUTS

INGREDIENTS

- 4 MEDIUM APPLES, CORED
- 2 TABLESPOONS HONEY
- 1 TEASPOON GROUND CINNAMON
- 50G WALNUTS, CHOPPED
- 1 TABLESPOON COCONUT OIL (OR BUTTER)

"Be stronger than your excuses."

These Baked Apples with Cinnamon and Walnuts are a warm and comforting dessert. The apples soften as they bake, and the cinnamon and walnuts bring out a lovely natural sweetness. It's a simple, healthy dessert that's perfect for colder days.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (350°F).
- Core the apples and place them in a baking dish.
- Drizzle honey over each apple and sprinkle with cinnamon.
- Fill the centre of each apple with chopped walnuts and a small amount of coconut oil.
- Cover with foil and bake for 20-25 minutes, or until the apples are tender.
- Serve warm.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 4

- CALORIES: 150 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 2G
- FAT: 10G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 20G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 16G
- SODIUM: 1MG
- CALCIUM: 20MG
- IRON: 1MG

CREAMY MANGO AND COCONUT DESSERT

INGREDIENTS

- 2 LARGE RIPE MANGOES (ABOUT 500 G / 1.1 LBS), PEELED AND DICED
- 300 G (1 1/4 CUPS) UNSWEETENED COCONUT YOGURT
- 2 TBSP HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP (OPTIONAL, DEPENDING ON MANGO SWEETNESS)
- 1 TSP LIME ZEST
- 1 TBSP DESICCATED COCONUT, TOASTED
- MINT LEAVES TO GARNISH

"One healthy meal won't change your life, but the habit of eating them will."

This Creamy Mango and Coconut Dessert is a luscious, tropical treat that's naturally sweetened and packed with flavour. Made with ripe mangoes and creamy coconut yogurt, it's a healthy and refreshing choice for a light dessert or snack.

- In a blender, puree the diced mango until smooth. Set aside a slice or two for garnish.
- In a bowl, whisk the coconut yogurt with honey or maple syrup (if using) and lime zest.
- In serving glasses, layer the coconut yogurt then the layer of mango puree.
- Top each glass with the reserved mango, possibly some toasted desiccated coconut, and a sprig of mint. Serve chilled.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2-3

- CALORIES: 190 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 3 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 30 G
- FAT: 7 G
- FIBRE: 3 G
- SUGAR: 25 G

AVOCADO AND CACAO MOUSSE

INGREDIENTS

- 2 RIPE AVOCADOS, PEELED AND PITTED
- 50G RAW CACAO POWDER
- 2 TABLESPOONS MAPLE SYRUP (OR HONEY)
- 1 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT
- A PINCH OF SEA SALT

"When you feel like quitting, think about why you started."

This creamy Avocado and Cacao Mousse is a rich, chocolatey dessert that's also dairy-free and packed with healthy fats. The avocado creates a smooth, velvety texture, while the cacao gives it a deep, satisfying chocolate flavour.

- Blend all ingredients in a food processor until smooth and creamy.
- Taste and adjust sweetness if necessary, adding more maple syrup or honey.
- Spoon the mousse into serving cups and chill in the fridge for at least 1 hour before serving.
- Garnish with berries or crushed nuts if desired.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS SERVES 2

- CALORIES: 220 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 3G
- FAT: 18G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 20G, FIBRE: 10G, SUGARS: 6G
- SODIUM: 5MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 2MG

HOMEMADE COCONUT MACAROONS

INGREDIENTS

- 200G SHREDDED UNSWEETENED COCONUT
- 2 LARGE EGG WHITES
- 3 TABLESPOONS HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP
- 1 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT
- A PINCH OF SEA SALT

"Choose foods that love you back."

These homemade coconut macaroons are chewy, lightly sweet, and full of flavour. With just a few ingredients, they make a perfect gluten-free, healthy treat for anyone craving a coconut dessert.

- Preheat your oven to 160°C (320°F) and line a baking tray with parchment paper.
- In a large bowl, combine the coconut, egg whites, honey (or maple syrup), vanilla extract, and sea salt.
- Stir until fully mixed.
- Spoon the mixture into small mounds on the baking tray.
- Bake for 10-12 minutes, or until golden brown.
- Allow to cool before serving.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS MAKES AROUND 12

- CALORIES: 100 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 2G
- FAT: 7G, SATURATED FAT: 6G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 9G, FIBRE: 2G, SUGARS: 7G
- SODIUM: 15MG
- CALCIUM: 20MG
- IRON: 1MG

STRAWBERRY FROZEN YOGURT

INGREDIENTS

- 250G FRESH STRAWBERRIES, HULLED AND CHOPPED
- 300G GREEK YOGURT
- 2 TABLESPOONS HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP
- 1 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT

"*Exercise not because you hate your body, but because you love it.*"

This homemade Strawberry Frozen Yogurt is a healthy alternative to ice cream. Made with fresh strawberries and Greek yogurt, it's creamy, tangy, and naturally sweetened. It's a refreshing treat that's perfect for warm days.

- In a blender or food processor, blend the strawberries, Greek yogurt, honey (or maple syrup), and vanilla extract until smooth.
- Taste and adjust sweetness if necessary.
- Pour the mixture into a shallow dish or an ice cream maker.
- If using a shallow dish, freeze for 2-3 hours, stirring every 30 minutes to break up any ice crystals.
- Serve once frozen or keep in the freezer for later.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS MAKES AROUND 4

- CALORIES: 120 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 7G
- FAT: 4G, SATURATED FAT: 1G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 15G, FIBRE: 2G, SUGARS: 12G
- SODIUM: 30MG
- CALCIUM: 100MG
- IRON: 0.5MG

GRILLED PINEAPPLE WITH HONEY AND CINNAMON

INGREDIENTS

- 1 PINEAPPLE, PEELED, CORED, AND SLICED
- 2 TABLESPOONS HONEY
- 1 TEASPOON GROUND CINNAMON
- A PINCH OF SEA SALT

"*Nothing tastes as good as health feels.*"

Grilled Pineapple with Honey and Cinnamon is a simple yet delicious dessert. The natural sweetness of the pineapple intensifies as it grills, while the honey and cinnamon add warmth and flavour.

- Preheat the grill or a grill pan over medium heat.
- Brush the pineapple slices with honey and sprinkle with cinnamon and salt.
- Grill the pineapple for 2-3 minutes per side, until lightly charred.
- Serve immediately.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS MAKES AROUND 4

- CALORIES: 100 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 1G
- FAT: 0G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 26G, FIBRE: 3G, SUGARS: 20G
- SODIUM: 10MG
- CALCIUM: 20MG
- IRON: 0.5MG

BAKED PEARS WITH HONEY AND ALMONDS

INGREDIENTS

- 4 PEARS, HALVED AND CORED
- 2 TABLESPOONS HONEY
- 3 TEASPOONS OF RAISINS
- 50G ALMONDS, SLICED
- 1/2 TEASPOON GROUND CINNAMON
- 1 TABLESPOON BUTTER (OR COCONUT OIL)

"Don't stop when you're tired; stop when you're done."

Baked Pears with Honey and Almonds are a warm, comforting dessert that's perfect for cooler evenings. The pears soften and caramelise in the oven, while the almonds add a nice crunch and extra nutrients.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (350°F).
- Place the pear halves in a baking dish and drizzle with honey.
- Sprinkle with cinnamon and top with sliced almonds and raisins
- Dot with butter or coconut oil.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS MAKES AROUND 4

- CALORIES: 180 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 2G
- FAT: 10G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 25G, FIBRE: 5G, SUGARS: 20G
- SODIUM: 5MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 1MG

OATMEAL RAISIN COOKIES WITH COCONUT FLOUR

INGREDIENTS

- 100G COCONUT FLOUR
- 1/2 TEASPOON BAKING SODA
- 1/2 TEASPOON GROUND CINNAMON
- 1/4 TEASPOON SALT
- 2 LARGE EGGS
- 100G HONEY OR MAPLE SYRUP
- 1 TEASPOON VANILLA EXTRACT
- 100G ROLLED OATS
- 50G RAISINS

"Your body can stand almost anything; it's your mind you have to convince."

These Oatmeal Raisin Cookies made with coconut flour are a gluten-free twist on a classic. They're chewy, naturally sweet, and packed with fibre, making them a perfect healthier option for a sweet treat.

- Preheat the oven to 180°C (350°F) and line a baking tray with parchment paper.
- In a bowl, combine the coconut flour, baking soda, cinnamon, and salt.
- In another bowl, whisk together the eggs, honey (or maple syrup), and vanilla extract.
- Stir in the dry ingredients, followed by the oats and raisins.
- Drop spoonfuls of dough onto the baking tray.
- Bake for 10-12 minutes, until golden brown.
- Let cool before serving.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). THIS MAKES AROUND 12

- CALORIES: 120 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 3G
- FAT: 6G, SATURATED FAT: 3G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 15G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 8G
- SODIUM: 40MG
- CALCIUM: 20MG
- IRON: 1MG

SNACK IDEAS

One of the questions I always got asked when I was on my own weight loss and fitness journey was about snacks. I was disciplined and kept them to a minimum, however sometimes if I was doing extra long trail runs, my body needed the boost. So I made many of my own trail running snacks, which stopped me heading for the cake shop!

CRISPY ROASTED CHICKPEAS

INGREDIENTS

- 400 G (14 OZ) CAN CHICKPEAS, DRAINED AND RINSED
- 1 TBSP OLIVE OIL
- 1/2 TSP SMOKED PAPRIKA
- 1/2 TSP GARLIC POWDER
- 1/4 TSP GROUND CUMIN
- PINCH OF SALT AND PEPPER

"Fitness is not a destination; it's a way of life."

These Crispy Roasted Chickpeas are a savoury and crunchy snack that's rich in protein and fibre. They're easy to make, customisable with your favourite spices, and perfect for munching on the go or as a topping for salads.

- Preheat your oven to 200°C (400°F). Line a baking tray with parchment paper.
- Pat the chickpeas dry with a clean kitchen towel. Remove any loose skins for extra crispiness.
- In a bowl, toss the chickpeas with olive oil, smoked paprika, garlic powder, cumin, salt, and pepper until evenly coated.
- Spread the chickpeas on the baking tray in a single layer. Roast for 25-30 minutes, shaking the tray halfway through, until golden brown and crispy.
- Let them cool completely for maximum crunch. Store in an airtight container for up to 3 days.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). A HANDFUL

- CALORIES: 130 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 5 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 18 G
- FAT: 4 G
- FIBRE: 5 G
- SUGAR: 1 G

HUMMUS WITH CARROT AND CUCUMBER STICKS

INGREDIENTS

- 4 TABLESPOONS HUMMUS
- 1 CARROT, SLICED INTO STICKS
- 1 CUCUMBER, SLICED INTO STICKS

"Fill your plate with plants and your heart with gratitude."

Crunchy and satisfying, this snack provides fibre, protein, and healthy fats. Hummus is made from chickpeas, which offer plant-based protein to help keep you full.

- Wash and peel the carrot and cucumber.
- Slice them into sticks or rounds.
- Serve the veggie sticks with hummus on the side for dipping.
- Enjoy as a crunchy, satisfying snack!

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING) THE VALUES ASSUME ABOUT 4 TABLESPOONS OF STORE-BOUGHT HUMMUS (60G) AND STANDARD-SIZED CARROT AND CUCUMBER.

- CALORIES: 120 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 3G
- FAT: 6G (SATURATED FAT: 1G)
- CARBOHYDRATES: 12G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 5G
- SODIUM: 120MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 1MG

HARD-BOILED EGGS WITH AVOCADO

INGREDIENTS

- 2 HARD-BOILED EGGS
- 1/2 AVOCADO, SLICED
- A DRIZZLE OF OLIVE OIL
- 1 SMALL RED ONION SLICED
- SALT AND PEPPER TO TASTE OR CAYENNE PEPPER (MY FAVOURITE CHOICE)

"Eat to fuel your dreams, not just your hunger."

A simple yet filling snack with protein and healthy fats to curb hunger. Eggs are nutrient-dense, while avocado provides healthy fats and fibre.

- Place the eggs in a pot and cover with water.
- Bring to a boil, then lower the heat and simmer for 10-12 minutes.
- Remove the eggs, cool them under cold running water, and peel.
- Slice the avocado and serve with the hard-boiled eggs. Drizzle the oil over and add the red onion slices
- Season with salt and pepper to taste. Or I prefer the Fleur De Sel/Celtic Sea salt with some cayenne pepper dusted over.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING) THESE VALUES ARE BASED ON MEDIUM-SIZED EGGS (50G EACH) AND HALF A MEDIUM AVOCADO (75G). ADJUSTMENTS TO OLIVE OIL AND SEASONING WILL SLIGHTLY ALTER THE CALORIC AND FAT CONTENT.

- CALORIES: 250 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 12G
- FAT: 20G, SATURATED FAT: 4G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 6G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 1G
- SODIUM: 200MG (DEPENDING ON ADDED SALT)
- CALCIUM: 50MG
- IRON: 1.5MG

APPLE WITH PEANUT BUTTER

INGREDIENTS

- 1 MEDIUM APPLE, SLICED
- 2 TABLESPOONS PEANUT BUTTER (NATURAL, NO ADDED SUGAR)

"A healthy lifestyle begins with one positive choice at a time."

A sweet and savoury combination that's both filling and energising. Apples provide fibre, while peanut butter adds protein and healthy fats.

- Wash and slice the apple into wedges.
- Spread peanut butter onto each slice or dip the apple slices directly into the peanut butter.
- Enjoy!

NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING)THE VALUES ARE BASED ON ONE MEDIUM APPLE (200G) AND TWO TABLESPOONS OF NATURAL PEANUT BUTTER (32G).

- CALORIES: 200 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 6G
- FAT: 10G, SATURATED FAT: 2G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 25G, FIBRE: 4G, SUGARS: 18G
- SODIUM: 80MG (DEPENDING ON THE PEANUT BUTTER)
- CALCIUM: 20MG
- IRON: 0.5MG

COTTAGE CHEESE WITH BERRIES

INGREDIENTS

- 150G COTTAGE CHEESE
- 75G (1/2 CUP) MIXED BERRIES (BLUEBERRIES, RASPBERRIES, ETC.)
- ADDING A SPRINKLE OF CINNAMON OR A DRIZZLE OF HONEY CAN ENHANCE THE FLAVOUR WITHOUT ADDING TOO MANY CALORIES.

"Healthy food is the foundation of a healthy mind and body."

A satisfying, high-protein snack with a touch of sweetness from the berries. Cottage cheese is rich in casein protein, which digests slowly and helps with satiety. Eat on its own or with a cracker.

- Spoon the cottage cheese into a bowl.
- Top with fresh mixed berries.
- Stir gently or enjoy as is.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING):VALUES ARE BASED ON 150G OF LOW-FAT COTTAGE CHEESE AND 75G OF MIXED BERRIES.

- CALORIES: 150 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 15G
- FAT: 3G, SATURATED FAT: 2G (VARIES WITH COTTAGE CHEESE)
- CARBOHYDRATES: 10G, FIBRE: 2G, SUGARS: 8G
- SODIUM: 400MG (VARIES BY BRAND OF COTTAGE CHEESE)
- CALCIUM: 100MG
- IRON: 0.3MG

EDAMAME WITH SEA SALT

INGREDIENTS

- 155G SHELLED (1 CUP) STEAMED EDAMAME
- A PINCH OF SEA SALT
- TO ENHANCE THE FLAVOUR, YOU COULD ADD A SPRINKLE OF GARLIC POWDER, CHILLI FLAKES, OR A DASH OF LEMON JUICE.

"The closer your food is to nature, the better it is for you."

These protein-packed, fibre-rich edamame beans are great for curbing hunger. Lightly salted for flavour, they're a filling, plant-based snack.

- Steam the edamame beans according to the package instructions (usually about 5-10 minutes).
- Drain the beans and sprinkle with a pinch of sea salt.
- Serve warm or at room temperature.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING):

- CALORIES: 190 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 17G
- FAT: 8G, SATURATED FAT: 1G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 13G, FIBRE: 8G, SUGARS: 2G
- SODIUM: 150MG (DEPENDS ON THE AMOUNT OF SEA SALT USED)
- CALCIUM: 90MG
- IRON: 2.7MG

TRAIL MIX WITH NUTS AND SEEDS

INGREDIENTS

- 30G (1/4 CUP) MIXED NUTS (ALMONDS, WALNUTS, CASHEWS)
- 7G (1 TABLESPOON) SUNFLOWER SEEDS
- 7G (1 TABLESPOON) PUMPKIN SEEDS
- OPTIONAL: 7G (1 TABLESPOON) DRIED CRANBERRIES (UNSWEETENED)

"Every bite of real, wholesome food is a step towards a stronger you."

A combination of protein, fibre, and healthy fats, trail mix is a great on-the-go snack. Be sure to choose a mix without added sugars or preservatives.

- Combine the mixed nuts, seeds, and any dried fruit in a bowl or container.
- Stir to mix everything evenly.
- Portion out the trail mix into small snack-sized bags or containers for easy grab-and-go access.
- Enjoy as a quick, satisfying snack!

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING) - A GOOD HANDFUL!

- CALORIES: 180 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 5G
- FAT: 14G, SATURATED FAT: 1.5G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 8G
- FIBRE: 2G
- SUGARS: 2G (DEPENDS ON THE INCLUSION OF DRIED CRANBERRIES)
- SODIUM: 5MG
- CALCIUM: 30MG
- IRON: 1MG

VEGETABLE CHIPS (HOMEMADE)

INGREDIENTS

- 1 SMALL SWEET POTATO, THINLY SLICED
- 1 TABLESPOON OLIVE OIL
- CELTIC SEA SALT OR FLEUR DE SEL (HEALTHIER) WITH FINELY CHOPPED ROSEMARY

"Eating well is a way to love yourself every single day."

Baked vegetable chips are a healthy alternative to store-bought ones, made with nutrient-dense vegetables like kale, sweet potatoes, or zucchini. The fibre content helps keep you satisfied.

- Preheat your oven to 180°C (350°F).
- Slice the sweet potato (or any other vegetable you're using) thinly using a mandolin or sharp knife.
- Toss the vegetable slices in olive oil and season with the salt and rosemary.
- Lay the slices out in a single layer on a baking sheet.
- Bake for 15-20 minutes, flipping halfway through, until they are crispy and golden.
- Allow to cool before serving.

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING). SERVES 2-3 DEPENDING ON SIZE OF SWEET POTATO

- CALORIES: 100 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 1G
- FAT: 4.5G, SATURATED FAT: 0.5G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 13G
- FIBRE: 2G
- SUGARS: 3G
- SODIUM: 50MG
- CALCIUM: 15MG
- IRON: 0.5MG

TURKEY AND CHEESE ROLL-UPS

INGREDIENTS

- 3 SLICES TURKEY BREAST (DELI MEAT OR COOKED)
- 2 SLICES CHEESE (SUCH AS CHEDDAR, MOZZARELLA, OR SWISS)
- 2 LETTUCE LEAVES

"Work out because you love your body, not because you hate it."

These protein-packed roll-ups are simple to make and can curb hunger quickly. The combination of lean turkey and cheese provides a satisfying balance of protein and fats.

- Lay the slices of turkey breast flat on a cutting board or plate.
- Lay a lettuce leaf in.
- Place a slice of cheese on top of each turkey slice.
- Roll up the turkey and cheese into a tight roll. Then slice into sections.
- Repeat with the remaining slices.
- Serve immediately or keep chilled for a snack on the go.

NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING) BASED ON 1 SERVING (WHICH CONSISTS OF 1 ROLL-UP MADE FROM 1 SLICE OF TURKEY, 1 SLICE OF CHEESE, AND 1 LETTUCE LEAF):

- CALORIES: 150 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 14G
- FAT: 9G
- SATURATED FAT: 4G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 1G
- FIBRE: 0G
- SUGARS: 1G
- SODIUM: 400MG
- CALCIUM: 120MG
- IRON: 1MG

THIS NUTRITIONAL BREAKDOWN IS BASED ON THE FOLLOWING ASSUMPTIONS:

- 3 SLICES OF TURKEY BREAST (ABOUT 90G TOTAL)
- 2 SLICES OF CHEESE (EACH AROUND 20G, USING CHEDDAR AS THE EXAMPLE)
- 2 LARGE LETTUCE LEAVES

ZUCCHINI FRIES

INGREDIENTS

- 2 MEDIUM ZUCCHINIS (COURGETTE), SLICED INTO THIN FRIES
- 50G (1/2 CUP) BREADCRUMBS (PANKO BREADCRUMBS ARE THE BEST AND MAKE THEM EXTRA CRUNCHY)
- 25G (1/4 CUP) GRATED PARMESAN CHEESE
- 1 TSP GARLIC POWDER
- 1/2 TSP DRIED OREGANO
- 1/4 TSP SALT
- 1/4 TSP PEPPER
- 1 EGG, BEATEN

"Fall in love with taking care of yourself."

Zucchini Fries are a great healthy alternative to regular fries. They're low in calories, packed with fibre, and full of flavour. These crispy, oven-baked zucchini fries are perfect for snacking without the guilt.

- Preheat your oven to 200°C (400°F) and line a baking tray with parchment paper.
- In a shallow bowl, combine the breadcrumbs, parmesan cheese, garlic powder, oregano, salt, and pepper.
- Dip each zucchini fry into the beaten egg, then coat with the breadcrumb mixture. Place the coated zucchini fries on the prepared baking tray.
- Bake for 20-25 minutes, flipping halfway through, until the fries are golden and crispy.
- Serve immediately with your favourite dipping sauce.... healthy of course!

APPROXIMATE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (PER SERVING): SERVES 4

- CALORIES: 110 KCAL
- PROTEIN: 5 G
- CARBOHYDRATES: 15 G
- FAT: 4 G
- FIBRE: 3 G
- SUGAR: 4 G